Hifi Micromatic

Magnavox Micromatic: Record weight

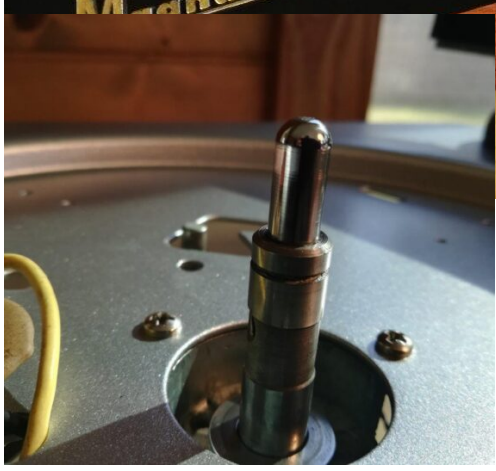
by Scorron82 | No Comments

In an effort to reduce rumble on my newly manualized Micromatic, I thought I would try a record weight. Some of them are quite expensive for, truly, nothing but a pound or so of weight to set on top of the record label while spinning. I knew I could make one easily, so I did.

Several grits of sandpaper allowed me to turn the stone down to a smooth shape with a finger groove. I actually used a Dremel 1/2″ sanding drum to shape the finger groove. I keep the shopvac going and close to my face while doing this, to keep the dust down.

I experimented with several materials for the bottom of the soapstone. I was trying to find something to improve grip, while at the same time, providing a soft material for centering on the spindle. The weight, being stone, makes scraping noises if not perfectly centered, so ideally, I would drill the center hole large and use a softer, quiet material to center the weight.

I tried neoprene rubber, which provided amazing grip, of course, but the tendency to grip the spindle was a major detriment. Felt would not, I think, improve grip at all. I settled on no material at all, but I believe the right answer is leather or cork. Perhaps in the future.



Magnavox Micromatic: Center bearing

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Magnavox Micromatic: Preamble to an obsession

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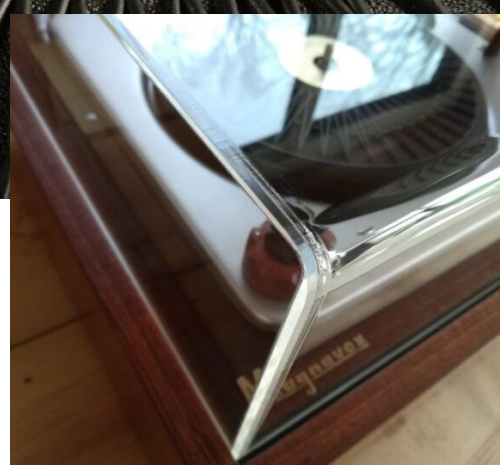

Magnavox Micromatic: Dust Cover

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